Adapted Screenplay — Majhi

CHITthi JO NAHI KHOLI
Majhi adaptation — rural Majha — Amritsar / Tarn Taran belt, Punjab
Output script: roman

SCENE 1
EXT. KOTHI DA AANGAN - EARLY MORNING

Brick kothi with a small aangan, iron gate that never latches, peepal shade at the wall, charpai against

A modest do-manzila kothi. Dew on the grass. A lohe da gate that never quite closes. Jaswant (28), restle
Bebe (55) watches from the verandah de darwaze, a phulkari-border dupatta around her shoulders. Simran (2
He turns the envelope over. The handwriting is his Mama's.
Jaswant does not answer. He puts the letter back in his khaddar jacket de pocket and walks toward the ras

SURJIT KAUR
Tu late aa gya, puttar. Jadon kujh gal hundi ae, tu aidaan hi ghumda ae.

JASWANT SINGH
Kujh gal nahi, Bebe. Saah lain nu bahar aaya si.

SIMRAN KAUR
Oh chiTThi do din to pocket vich pae. Ja khol, ja Bebe nu de de.

SURJIT KAUR
Je mere veer di chiTThi ae te eh ghar di gal ae. Ghar di gal merethon lukai nahi jaandi.

SCENE 2
INT. RASOI - MORNING

Smoke-darkened rasoi with a gas stove, steel glasses, aluminium kettle, and a wooden almirah of masala ti

Steam from a aluminium kettle. Three steel glasses wait on the table. The rasoi is the true centre of the
Silence. Jaswant's hand stays on the pocket that holds the letter. The aluminium kettle clicks off.
Jaswant sits. He does not take the letter out. Simran places a cup in front of him, then one in front of
Jaswant stands, still carrying the letter, and leaves through the back door. Simran starts to speak, then

HARPREET SINGH
Aidaan lagda ae jaan shart haar ke rasta vi haar aaya hovein, yaar.

JASWANT SINGH
Mama Jagtar ne likheya ae. Ohnu shop chahidi ae mere kolon. Bebe hun vi samajhdi ae main padhda peaa haan.

SIMRAN KAUR
Tainu ohnau dassiya si ikk saal baaki ae.

SURJIT KAUR
Main sunn rahi haan. Apni rasoi vich main koi parai nahi.

SURJIT KAUR
Beh ja. Chai pee le. Phir sach dass, oh gal nahi jo tu bazaar vaaste tyaar karke rakhi ae.

JASWANT SINGH
Kam ton baad, Bebe. Main dasanga kam ton baad.

SURJIT KAUR
Kam ton baad di gal naal jhooth buddha ho janda ae.

SCENE 3
EXT. PIND DA CHOWK / MANDI ROAD - AFTERNOON

Open mandi road with kiryana, cycle-repair, and a reri of kulche-chole; buses throw dust

A busy street of small shops, buses, and heat. Jaswant walks with Harpreet. The letter is still in his po

They stop near a kulche-chole di reri. Jaswant almost opens the envelope, then puts it away again. He keeps the letter. They part. The pind da chowk continues without noticing.

HARPREET SINGH
Je shop le li, tu pind vich rehna. Te je rehana, oh bande banjna jehda Bebe ne paise nu pehlan hi dass chhaddiya ae.

JASWANT SINGH
Je na kar ditta, Bebe kahegi main Mama de kam ton sharmaunda haan.

HARPREET SINGH
Phir gall gali vich na kar. Ghar ja, Bebe tere moonh te vece je tu gall karein.

HARPREET SINGH
Simran jaandi ae. Bebe lagbhag jaandi ae. Naatak sirf tu karan peaa ae.

JASWANT SINGH
Shaam ton pehlan ghar jaanga. Kise paraye di himmat chukk ke nahi avanga.

SCENE 4
INT. BAITHAK - EVENING

Baithak with one sofa, floor dari, framed family photograph, and a low table for the letter

The house is quieter. A single lamp. Bebe sits in the Bebe di kursi. Simran stands near the window. Jaswa
He takes the envelope out and places it on the chhoti mez between them. He does not sit until Bebe nods.
Bebe picks up the letter, feels its weight, and does not open it yet. She looks at her son, then at her d
Simran sits. Jaswant sits. The letter stays on the table, no longer hidden, not yet finished.

JASWANT SINGH
Mama ne course chhadd ke kiryana sambhalan nu keha ae. ChiTThi is vaaste lukai kyunki mainu darr si tuhanu niiraan na kar deaan.

SURJIT KAUR
Niiraan te main seh laini aan, puttar. Par ghar vich aakhri jaanan vaali nahi ban sakdi.

SIMRAN KAUR
Assi tere naal behnde. Eh kothi da matlab hi eh ae.

JASWANT SINGH
Maaf kar de, Bebe. Shop baare hun vi pakka nahi. Pakka eh ae ke pehlan dassna chahida si.

SURJIT KAUR
Phir assaN ikkThhe paRhange. Us ton baad tu oh dass jehda tainu chahida ae, oh nahi jehda tainu lagda ae main seh sakdi haan.

END.